



YASINDAR



PTI PHOTO

AMETHI STEEL PLANT

Paswan with Rahul Gandhi during the foundation stone laying ceremony of the rebuilding of a steel plant at Amethi in February



PHOTO DIVISION



SHEERAZ RIZVI

NEHRU GRAM BHARTI

Union HRD Minister Arjun Singh inaugurates Nehru Gram Bharti University at Kotwa Jamunipur in Uttar Pradesh in January

cially buffalo meat. "The modernisation of slaughter houses is an old proposal. This is merely an election strategy to woo a certain section of voters," says Mukhtar Abbas Naqvi, BJP vice-president.

Then there are other projects, bursting at the seams with political convenience. Ignoring desperate pleas

of Trinamool Congress supremo Mamata Banerjee, the UPA cleared two major industrial projects for West Bengal, a petrochemical hub at Nayachar and a biotech project at Kalyani. While attending the stone-laying of Kolkata's proposed East-West Metro Corridor at Salt Lake, External Affairs Minister Pranab

Mukherjee even obliquely hit out at Banerjee, stating that "some people were putting up obstacles to the state's development" in an attempt to please the Left, a potential post-poll ally.

Civil Aviation Minister Praful Patel flew around the country inaugurating airport terminals (see box). Sonia laid foundation stones for an IIT in

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